

Do-It-Yourself Credit Repair Kit

Fix Your Credit, One Small Step at a Time

Credit Repair Services • Jessica Alvarez • San Antonio, Texas

You can do this. This kit shows you each step in plain, easy words. Go slow. Do one step at a time. Check the box when you finish a step. Most people need 3 to 6 months. That is normal.

Words to know first

- **Credit report:** a list of your loans and cards, and how you paid them.
- **Credit bureau:** a company that keeps your credit report. There are 3 big ones: Experian, Equifax, and TransUnion.
- **Dispute:** when you tell a bureau, “This is wrong. Please fix it.”
- **Creditor:** the company you owe, or owed, money to.
- **Balance:** how much you still owe on a card or loan.

Step 1 — Get Your Credit Reports (Free)

Go to **AnnualCreditReport.com**. It is the free site the law gives you. Get all 3 reports: Experian, Equifax, and TransUnion. Save them or print them. Do not pay for your reports on other sites.

- ☐ I got my Experian report.
- ☐ I got my Equifax report.
- ☐ I got my TransUnion report.

Step 2 — Read Your Reports and Mark What Is Wrong

Read each report slow. Use a pen or a highlighter. Mark anything that looks wrong. Look for:

- An account that is **not yours**.
- A name, address, or job that is not yours.
- The same debt listed **two times**.
- A payment marked “late” when you paid on time.
- A wrong balance — it says you owe more than you do.
- A very old debt. Most bad items must come off after **7 years**.
- An account marked “open” that you closed, or “closed” that is open.

Write each wrong item on your Tracking Sheet (page 5). One line for each item.

Step 3 — Get Your Proof Papers Together

The bureau needs to know you are you. Make copies — never send your real ones:

- ☐ Copy of your photo ID (driver's license or state ID).
- ☐ Copy of a bill with your name and home address, dated in the last 60 days (light bill, water bill, or bank paper).
- ☐ Any proof that helps you. Paid a bill they say is late? Copy the proof you paid.
- ☐ Keep all your copies in one folder. You will use this folder a lot.

Step 4 — Pick the First Items to Dispute

Start with the easy ones first:

- Wrong name or wrong address.
- Accounts that are not yours.
- The same debt listed two times.
- Very old items (over 7 years).

Pick up to **5 items** for your first dispute. You can do more later. Small steps win.

Step 5 — Write Your Dispute Letter

Copy Letter A (page 4). Fill in the blanks by hand or on a computer. Write neat. Keep it short and true. Only dispute things that are truly wrong. Never lie on a dispute.

Where to mail your letter:

- **Experian:** P.O. Box 4500, Allen, TX 75013 — you can also dispute on experian.com/disputes.
- **Equifax:** P.O. Box 105069, Atlanta, GA 30348-5069.
- **TransUnion:** P.O. Box 2000, Chester, PA 19016.

Send the letter to the bureau whose report has the mistake. A mistake on all 3 reports needs 3 letters — one to each bureau.

Step 6 — Mail It the Right Way

- ☐ Put your letter, your ID copy, and your address proof in the envelope.
- ☐ Make a copy of the full set for your folder **before** you mail it.
- ☐ Mail it **certified mail, return receipt requested** at the post office. It costs a few dollars. It proves they got it.
- ☐ Write the date you mailed it on your Tracking Sheet.

Step 7 — Wait, Then Read the Answer

The bureau has about **30 days** to check your dispute. They will mail you a letter with the result. It will say one of these:

- **Deleted:** the item is gone. Great — that is a win.
- **Changed:** they fixed part of it. Check that the fix is right.
- **Verified / stays:** they say it is right, so it stays for now. Go to Step 8.

Write the result on your Tracking Sheet. Put the letter in your folder.

Step 8 — Still Wrong? Dispute One More Time

Use Letter B (page 4). Say the item is still wrong. Add any new proof you have. You can also ask: “How did you check this?” The bureau must tell you how they checked. If a bureau or a company will not fix a real mistake, you can file a free

complaint at **consumerfinance.gov** (the CFPB).

Step 9 — Build Good Credit While You Wait

Fixing old mistakes is only half the job. New good habits raise your score over time:

- **Pay every bill on time.** Set phone alarms if you need to. One late pay can hurt a lot.
- **Keep card balances low.** Owe less than 30% of your limit. Less than 10% is even better. If your limit is \$1,000, try to owe less than \$300 — best is less than \$100.
- **Do not apply for new cards or loans** while you fix your credit, unless you have a clear plan.
- **Do not close old cards.** Old cards help your score. Just keep the balance low.
- **Check your reports again** in 3 to 4 months to see your wins.

DIY CREDIT KIT

Letter A — Your First Dispute (Copy and Fill In)

[Your full name]

[Your home address]

[City, State, ZIP]

[Date]

[Bureau name and address — from Step 5]

Dear Sir or Madam:

I looked at my credit report and found a mistake. Please check it and fix it.

Name of company: _____

Account number (as shown on my report): _____

The mistake is: _____

It should say: _____

By law, you must check this and fix or take off anything you cannot prove is right. Please send me a new copy of my report when you are done, and tell me how you checked this item.

I put copies of my photo ID and a bill with my address in this envelope.

Thank you,

[Your signature]

[Your printed name]

Date of birth: _____ Last 4 of Social Security number: _____

Letter B — Second Dispute (If It Is Still Wrong)

Use the same start as Letter A. Then write:

"You told me this item was checked, but it is still wrong. The mistake is:

_____. Here is my proof: _____. Please check again. Tell me how you checked it the first time — who you talked to and what papers you used. If you cannot prove it is right, please take it off my report."

Letter C — Goodwill Letter (For One Late Pay)

Send this one to the **company**, not the bureau. Use it for one late pay on an account that is good other than that. Keep it short and kind:

"Dear [Company]: I have been your customer since [year]. I was late one time, in [month, year], because [one short, true reason]. I have paid on time since then. Would you please, as a kind favor, take that one late mark off my credit report? It would help my family a lot. Thank you for your time."

The company does not have to say yes. It costs nothing to ask, in a kind way.

My Tracking Sheet

Write down every letter you send. This is how you stay on track.

Date I mailed it	Sent to (bureau or company)	Item / account	What I said was wrong	Answer date	Result

My scores: Start: Experian _____ Equifax _____ TransUnion _____ After 3 months: _____ / _____ / _____ After 6 months: _____ / _____ / _____

Do This / Not This

DO: tell the truth • keep copies of all you send • mail with proof (certified mail)
• pay all bills on time • be patient — this takes months, and that is okay.

DO NOT: lie on a dispute • pay a company that says “we can erase true debts” — no one can • give your Social Security number to a site you do not trust • stop paying bills that are truly yours.

One last thing: this kit teaches you to do what the law lets any person do for free — check your own reports and dispute real mistakes. No kit and no person can promise a set score or promise to erase true debts. If you get stuck and want it done for you, you can use your \$25 kit price toward a done-for-you plan with Credit Repair Services within 30 days — just ask Jessica.